SS-B-691b
June 9, 1965
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. SS-B-00691a
September 9, 1963, and
Fed. Spec. SS-B-691
October 3, 1933

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BRICK, SEWER, (CLAY OR SHALE)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers clay or shale sewer brick.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Grades.* The brick shall be of the following grades, as specified (see 6.2):

Grade SA—Brick impervious and resistant to large quantities of abrasive materials at velocities exceeding 8 feet per second.

Grade MA—Brick impervious and resistant to quantities of abrasive materials at velocities of 8 feet per second or less.

Grade NA—Brick not requiring a high degree of imperviousness nor of abrasive resistance.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:13Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MIL–STD–147—Palletized Unit Loads (40″ x 48″ 4-Way Partial and 4-Way Pallets).

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply:

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Publications:

C 32—Specification for Sewer Brick (Made from Clay or Shale).

C 67—Methods of Sampling and Testing Brick.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, Pa., 19103.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Each grade of brick shall meet the requirements of ASTM C 32.

3.2 Size. Size of the brick shall be as specified (see 6.2 and 6.3).

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any other commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling. The lot size and sample bricks required for visual examination, dimensional characteristics, and test shall be in accordance with ASTM C 67.

4.3 **Test.** Brick shall be tested in accordance with ASTM C 67.

4.4 Inspection of preparation for delivery. The packing and marking of the brick shall be inspected to determine conformance with the applicable requirements of section 5.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 *Levels A and B.* The bricks shall be palletized into unit loads in accordance with the requirements of MIL–STD–147.

5.1.2 *Level C.* The bricks shall be packed to assure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination at the lowest rate.

5.2 Marking.

5.2.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.2.2 *Military activities.* In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL–STD–129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.

6.1.1 *Grade SA.* Brick intended for use in structures requiring imperviousness and resistance to the action of sewage carrying large quantities of abrasive material at velocities exceeding 8 feet per second.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:13Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.1.2 *Grade MA.* Brick intended for use in structures requiring imperviousness and resistance to the action: (1) of sewage free from abrasive materials, and (2) of sewage carrying abrasive materials at velocities of 8 feet per second or less.

6.1.3 *Grade NA.*[1] Brick intended for use in structures not requiring high degrees of imperviousness nor of abrasive resistance.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(*b*) Grade of brick desired (1.2.1).

(*c*) Size of brick desired (3.2 and 6.3).

(*d*) Level of packing required (5.1).

(*e*) Marking required (5.2).

6.3 Size. The size of the brick shall be as specified by the purchaser. The purchaser may specify one of the standard sizes of either building brick or paving brick.

6.4 Supersession data for grades.

SS–B–691	*This specification*
Grade A	Grade SA
Grade B	Grade MA
Grade C	Grade NA

6.5 Transportation description. The transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Brick, building, common (sewer).

Carload minimum weight 60,000 pounds.

Motor:

Brick, building, common (sewer).

Truckload minimum weight 60,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

MILITARY INTEREST:

Army—MO (ERDL)

Navy—YD

Air Force—69

Review Interest:

MO, YD, 69

User Interest:

MR, MU

[1] Brick of grade NA are suitable for use in catch basins, arches, manholes, and for backing.

☆ U.S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE: 1965—753337/510

Copies of this specification may be purchased for 5 cents each.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:13Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.